

Key findings:

More than half the UPS devices owned by our respondents are from APC. Microtek had a market share of 16.67 percent while Intex had a share of 8.33 percent.

When it came to aided brand recall the results were a bit surprising. More people had heard of Microtek, the second runner up as compared to APC the winner. 79.31 per cent people remembered

APC when prompted while 81.03 percent recalled Microtek.

The same trend was noticed when it came to availability. More number of people felt that Microtek was more easily avail-

able than APC, both in terms of brand presence in shops and the availability of desired models.

(Visit www.thinkdigit.com/iot2012 for more details)



Laptops

Way back in 2008 when global Laptop sales first crossed desktop sales, the new era of mobile computing was ushered in. This year too there was a lot of action in this space. Second generation Sandy Bridge processors ensured that high performance notebooks didn't burn a hole in your pocket. Most of the components starting from the processors have now started to become even more power efficient than what we have seen before. Since portability is the way to go and battery technology is not innovating at the same rate, the only option was to make existing components more power efficient.

Consumers this year were spoilt for choice. Through the year we saw almost every notebook line from each brand such

as IdeaPad (Lenovo), Vostro (Dell), Timeline X (Acer), Pavillion (HP), VAIO (Sony) refreshed with better designs. Another trend is OEMs offering better bundled software rather than bloat and junk that we had seen so far. Vendors have started giving better software such as webcam utilities and cloud backups suites etc. The thin and light form factor seemed to have found more traction towards the end of the year. Going by this trend Ultrabooks which are slated to flood the markets this year, will determine the outcome of next year's IOT. More in our cover story.

This year's most trusted brand was as expected was Dell with a score of 70.24. A lot of things have worked in Dell's favour, a brand that as recently as 2008 was languishing at the number 5 spot. It gained five places in 2009 to emerge at the top and has resolutely stayed there since. Coming back to what has probably worked in Dell's favour: Dell follows a unique distribution model in which consumers can order directly



DELL
Dell's unique distribution model has worked for it again. It is this year's most trusted brand with a score of 70.24.

from the vendor, effectively cutting out the middle man. It also allows customization of components and there's a laptop at every price point on offer.

The second place was claimed by Sony followed closely by HP and Apple. Sony gained one place since the previous Icons of Trust while HP lost one place slipping to number three from the number two spot. Lenovo, once a winner of Icons of Trust dropped down to the fifth spot on our icons of trust index. But with a strong marketing push and interesting offerings next year's outlook seems to be promising for the Chinese brand

came in second. Apple and Sony had equal recall value - 11.5 percent.

2. Just nine percent of all those surveyed own two or more laptops. One of the lowest for any category. 3. When it came to perceptions of quality Apple emerged with the highest scores. It scored 85 percent on our five point weighted average scale while Dell scored 78 percent

4. Sony is perceived to be almost as stylish as Apple, attaining a score of 88.4 per cent in this department which is only slightly behind Apple with a score of 89.8 per cent.

5. HP scored slightly higher than Dell when it came to the brand's presence in stores. However in terms of availability of desired models it lagged behind by a significant margin. On specific availability Dell scored 77 per cent while HP scored 67 per cent. 6. In terms of Brand Loyalty maximum number of people strongly felt that they would go in for another product from Sony.

Key findings:

1. Unaided, Dell was the most recalled brand in our survey. 45 percent of our respondents could recall Dell while only 16 percent remembered HP which

